

JORDAN RIVERA

Backend Java Developer

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PROFILE

Platform engineer with **10+ years** building resilient document-generation pipelines, layout engines, and developer-facing template systems. Specialised in high-throughput PDF rendering, semantic authoring DSLs, and turning brittle production-ops scripts into typed, snapshot-tested libraries that scale.

SKILLS

- Languages: Java 21, Kotlin, Groovy, Python, SQL
- Document & Print: PDFBox, Apache POI (DOCX/XLSX), iText, PostScript, ICC colour profiles, font metrics
- Layout engines: Custom DSL design, semantic layout trees, pagination, snapshot testing, visual regression
- Build & infrastructure: Maven, Gradle, GitHub Actions, JitPack, Docker, JMH benchmarking
- Testing: JUnit 5, AssertJ, PDFBox-based PNG diff, layout-graph snapshots, mutation testing (Pitest)
- Distribution: Maven Central, Sonatype OSSRH, GPG signing, JitPack, semantic versioning discipline

EDUCATION

MSc Computer Science - University of Manchester | 2021.
Distinction. Thesis: *Composable layout primitives for deterministic document rendering*.

BSc Software Engineering - Imperial College London | 2019.
First-class honours. Specialisation in compilers and static analysis.

Oracle Java Certification - Professional track | 2023. Java 17 platform deep-dive: records, sealed types, pattern matching, virtual threads.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer, Northwind Systems | 2024-Present
- Led the reusable document-generation platform serving billing, hiring, and reporting flows across **8 product teams**. Reduced template maintenance time by **70%** by retiring per-team PDF scripts in favour of one canonical engine.

Software Engineer, BrightLeaf Labs | 2021-2024 - Built backend services and production document rendering pipelines processing **2M+ documents per month**. Drove the migration from iText to a custom layout engine, eliminating licensing risk and cutting p99 render latency from 1.4s to 380ms.

Backend Engineer, Helix Print Co | 2019-2021 - Maintained a high-volume invoice-printing service (15M PDFs/year) and authored the compliance test harness that gated every template change.

PROJECTS

- **GraphCompose** - Declarative Java PDF layout engine. Semantic DSL, slot-based templates, snapshot testing. Powers production CV / invoice / proposal pipelines for hiring tools and billing systems. (Open source)
- **Template Studio** - Internal tool for evaluating CV, proposal, and invoice output across 14 design presets. PNG diffing, side-by-side layout, baseline freezing.
- **LayoutLint** - Static analyser that flags fragile authoring patterns (deeply nested rows, untyped offsets, implicit page breaks) before they ship to production.
- **ChromeForge** - Editorial-magazine document toolkit built on GraphCompose: cinematic covers, pull quotes, multi-column flow, sidebar callouts.

ADDITIONAL

Languages: English (Fluent), German (Intermediate), Spanish (Basic)

Work Eligibility: Eligible to work in the UK and the EU

Open Source: Maintainer of GraphCompose. Regular contributor to PDFBox issue triage.

Speaking: JVM Summit 2024, Devox UK 2025 — both on declarative document layout.